

MYTH 1: WEALTHY PEOPLE INHERITED ALL THEIR MONEY

TRUTH: 79% of millionaires received zero inheritance, meaning only 21% received any inheritance at all. 84% received \$0 to \$100,000, which means that 84% of millionaires did not receive enough inheritance to make them millionaires.

Have you ever heard the term *celebutante*? It's a mashup of the words *celebrity* and *debutante* that the entertainment media industry came up with. They use it to describe someone who is famous for being famous. That is, these are people who haven't personally done much, but who are rich and famous anyway. Reality television is littered with men and women like this. Everyone seems to know who they are. The funny thing is, no one really knows why. And yet, there they are, clogging my social media news feed and screaming for my attention on television. This really bugged me early in my career. I was working my tail off trying to provide for my family, and yet I saw all these social media stars raking in money hand over fist. For a hard-charging, hardworking guy like me, it was a little frustrating.

My perspective has changed over the years, though. What ticks me off *these* days is that people actually believe this ridiculous stereotype is what a typical millionaire looks like. They see a celebrity's child and say, "I'll never be wealthy because I don't come from money." If that sounds like you, you're telling yourself a lie, and you're using that lie to excuse your own shortcomings. Excuses won't take you where you want to go, so it's time to shut them down.